

Rembrandt (single, triangle), Split (side, highlight v shadow side), Broad v Short, Butterfly/Beauty (above camera high + bounce), Loop (above high, to a side of camera, higher than rembrandt)

Ask David Mullen ASC anything - <http://reduser.net/forum/showthread.php?2714-Ask-David-Mullen-ANYTHING/page427>

Roger Deakins - <http://www.rogerdeakins.com/forum2/>

Cinematography.com

Cinematography.net

CML Mailing List

American Cinematography Manual
ASC Magazine

BOOKS - Cinematography, Five C's, Camera Assistants Manual

FILM STILLs

<http://filmgrab.wordpress.com/>

<http://film-grab.com/>

<http://movie-screencaps.com/>

<http://framefilter.blogspot.com/>

<http://evanerichards.com/posts>

<http://www.leavemethewhite.com/index2.html>

<http://moviegrabs.tumblr.com/>

<https://stillsfrmfilms.wordpress.com/>

<http://netflixscreencaps.tumblr.com/archive>

<https://joesmoviestuff.blogspot.com/>

Shotdeck.com

moodframe.co

Magnum (for photos)

<http://mellowyknox.tumblr.com/> - commercials

<http://setlighting.tumblr.com/>

Evan E. Richards – Cinematography Frame Grabs

<http://wanderingdp.com/>

<http://www.cinematographydb.com/>

<https://artsandculture.google.com/>

https://images.nga.gov/en/page/show_home_page.html

<https://www.wga.hu/index1.html>

Snap grid
Camouflage grid
Book light
Big lighting units
Dimmers
Practicals

COLOR GRADING

Shadows sit at 3.5 ire / 36 10-bit scale

Highlights max at 92-94 ire / 935-960 10-bit scale

Color Grading

Denoise (2 and 10)

LUT (after all the parallels)

IN PARALLEL:

Exposure + Color Balance

Lighting

Look (using Log)

Skin (Hue vs Sat)

Light Manipulation

Power Masks

Contrast in Areas

AFTER:

Shadows (Luma vs Sat Curve)

Deepen or Lift Blacks

Extra Value

Highlight Pop (Luminance Qualifier + Curve)

Sharpen (Sharpen and Midtone Details)

INTERVIEW Process - check email for interview questions

Similar projects with a similar scope?

How far along are you in your process?

What kind of equipment have you thought about using or is that all up to me? Preferred camera, film stock, lighting setups, and looks?

What is your vision for the film?

Ideas?

Lighting & camera movement

Favorite scene. Pivotal scene.

Story is King. Collaborating. I like getting involved early on.

Camera tech, lighting techniques, fun to be around

connection to great crew

Where is the story set & where will it be shot? Studio. Location.

Tone, Look, Budget. Days?

Favorite artist or photographer. Favorite DP. Favorite films.

Do they follow directions? Are they creative, nice problem solvers? Are they an artist or artisan - funny serious - good with actors, good with your vibe - go with the flow or more controlling. References are a good idea. Reels are one thing - working with them is another.

I'm positive, cheerful

You may announce the film being in prep in the trades like Variety and Hollywood Reporter and get unsolicited resumes, etc. You can also contact the below-the-line agencies, or they may contact you, and get reels and resumes from their clients. You may already have a DP in mind and contact them directly, or go through their agent.

You send them the script first, then schedule an interview between him and the director, in person if possible, over the phone if not. If the director wants that DP, the DP may also have to interview with the producer as well. Or the director and producer may want to be together when they interview the DP -- just depends on how they like to work together.

Then the producer would make an offer to the DP or their agent.

In terms of how early, well, a lot of it depends on if your shooting dates are locked, which depend on money & casting. You want to be reasonably sure about when the start date is, partially because some DP's contracts will have a guarantee -- i.e. once they are hired, they get paid for "x" time no matter what. It may be a 3-week guarantee, for example. Or less if you are a smaller movie.

Often a DP needs to spend about a month in prep for a month or so amount of shooting, even though they will probably only work sporadically in the first few weeks of prep, going on scouts, meeting with the director, etc. Of course, you may not be able to afford to pay a DP for a month of prep. You may have only budgeted two weeks of prep for a four week shoot, let's say, so it will be the DP's prerogative how much time they want to put in before the two-week paid period begins. They will probably say that they will make themselves available when needed but also be free to work on small shoots, etc. before that date.

So in other words, you probably want to start looking about two months maybe before the start date of shooting a feature and have someone in place a month before the start date

Be passionate

The DP is asked if they liked the script, what they thought about it, if they have any ideas, then there is much chit-chat as the DP gets to know the director, know more about the production, the logistics, etc. (the DP is interviewing the production as much as they are interviewing the DP.) DP does his best to sound excited about what is often a problematic script, but no one really wants to hear a DP's criticisms of the script EVEN IF THEY ARE ASKED FOR AN OPINION. If you want the job, don't be critical. Anyone about to drop a lot of money into a feature project is extremely nervous and desperately wants to believe that the script is hot, so what they are looking for in a DP is enthusiasm, enough to match theirs. They won't hire someone who sounds ambivalent about the script -- nor should they really, if there is another equally-skilled DP out there who is truly passionate about the material.

4 qualities one should convey in an interview: Energy, enthusiasm, confidence, and dependability.

The funny thing is, as a DP, you do have to know when to stop being a perfectionist. Another question was "What do you like to do in your spare time?", and the answer is "I like to research my job, because I like it even if I'm not getting paid." Funny enough, I'm always thinking about lighting, and I do often shoot for little or no money!

Prep & Process

Where do you start in prep and in your process as a DP?

How do you approach reading scripts (the first time, the second time, etc).

What does your typical prep process look like?

Can you chat about what your prep process usually looks like - from your first read, breaking it down, generating ideas, then taking that through to execution on set?

How do you prefer working with directors during this time?

How do you shot list with directors?

What is your approach to coverage and shotlisting?

If you had very little time to prep, what things would you focus on?

Typically how are you communicating your needs to production, crew, director, etc?

Do you have specific systems, resources, software, tools you use for prep and arranging everything in prep and during the shoot?

What do you like to focus on during director's scouts, tech scouts, etc? Can you describe what each is like usually for you?

How do you keep your crews on the same page throughout a project?

What do you enjoy the most about the script to screen process? What frustrates you the most? What part of it do you feel you excel at the most? What are you looking to improve?

How do you balance going from creative to execution? How do you grapple with and juggle the ideas, techniques, technical knowledge, budget, crew, what is practical and possible, what to tweak, and when to fight for your art and vision?

How often do you use storyboards, shotlist, overheads, tests, etc? Which helps you the most?

What is your philosophy or reasoning when choosing an aspect ratio? What story elements, practical considerations, and creative choices inform your decision?

What do you use on set: ipad, binder, phone, etc to keep track of it all?

Career

What were significant changes going from indie features to TV?

Did you find the pace and scale to be different? How did you cope and get on top of it?

What's the secret to ripping through copious amounts of pages per day?

In your career, at each stage, how did you deal with bigger budgets, bigger crews, etc?

What tips, techniques, concepts, revelations helped you advance in your career?

At certain budget levels there are "standard" or "typical" expectations of a DP, their process, and the more managerial aspects. How do you stay on top of and ahead of all the minutia, politics, and grind of DPing on larger shoots? How does it compare to indie shoots?

How do you work ahead with rigging crews? Multiple cameras? 2nd Units?

What does your collaboration with production designers, costumes, hair & makeup, etc usually look like? How do you help everyone stay in sync?

Personal

What are your top three favorite lighting techniques or approaches philosophically, artistically, or creatively to lighting?

Favorite light, lenses, look, or aesthetic (in your own work, in others, in general)?

What is your approach to filming dark scenes? Lighting, monitoring,

What references do you always go back to? Where do you find them?

Why do you shoot? Why did you start?

What tech, styles, stories, changes in the industry are you excited about?

How do you stay creatively inspired and grow the well of idea resources?

How do you usually spend your time when you're not working?

What shows and movies are you following?

How would you describe your style? What is style?

Favorite color?

Favorite book?

Lighting, Color Palette, Contrast,
Composition, Aspect Ratio, Negative Space, Centered, Symmetry or NO,
Lensing, Atmosphere, Depth, Texture, Details, Environment+Location, Character
Movement, Pacing (Intro, Hold, Frenetic)
Core Story, Big Picture
Visual References
beat sheet / character breakdowns / motivation
emotion / subtext / themes / arcs / story
visual / composition / light / color / mood
beats / phrases / sequences
scene by scene / shot by shot
shotlist
techniques / technical / process
lookbook